

The Course Master Method — Pilot Syllabus

Dates: October 5th to November 2 **Instructor:** Dr. Lawrence Gray **Class Meetings:** Monday at 11 AM MDT, 2 hours on Google Meet (5 weekly sessions) **Location:** Course materials on GitHub — https://github.com/lawrencegray-brt/how_to_build_a_course (no account needed; click the green **Code** button, then **Download ZIP**) **Office Hours:** By appointment

PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

This five-week pilot teaches subject-matter experts a repeatable method for building high-quality courses and training — the same method behind the program’s flagship courses. It is hands-on and production-focused: you bring a real subject you want to teach, and you leave with a real course-in-progress, not notes about course design.

Through instructor-led sessions and guided production between meetings, you will turn a subject into measurable learning objectives, a Master Design Document, and one fully-built module — applying values-first design, Bloom’s taxonomy, research-based teaching practices, and GenAI production under guardrails. No prior course-design experience is required.

The pilot mirrors the method it teaches: each module is delivered in the same three-package structure (instructor materials, student materials, a portable teaching guide) you are learning to build, so you experience the method while learning it.

COURSE-LEVEL LEARNING OBJECTIVES

Upon successful completion, you will be able to:

1. Write course- and module-level learning objectives using Bloom’s measurable verbs.
2. Audit a course design against the seven research-based teaching practices to find gaps.
3. Produce a complete Master Design Document for a course.
4. Build one fully-realized module across all three packages (instructor, student, teaching guide).
5. Direct GenAI to draft materials and evaluate its output against guardrails for correctness and tone.
6. Embed your organization’s values into course activities and assessments.
7. Apply accessibility (UDL) principles so your course works for diverse learners.
8. Plan how to evaluate a delivered course and improve it for the next run.

READINGS AND COURSE MATERIALS

All materials are provided in your Participant Packet:

- **How to Build a Course** — the method guide (your reference all five weeks; Bloom verbs and the practice question bank are in its appendices).
- **Blank templates** — Decisions document, Master Design Document, Seven-Practices audit, and the medium-neutral Module Skeleton.
- **The Contact-Hour companion** — for sizing a module to its time.
- **Two worked examples** — Intro-to-ML (a code course) and Home Coffee Brewing (a non-code course) — copy from whichever fits your subject.

Access to a GenAI tool (e.g., ChatGPT or Claude) is expected for the production work. An **agent-capable** tool — VS Code with Copilot in agent mode, or Claude Code — is optional; it unlocks the steps the Guide and the Directing AI card tag **RUN**, where the AI reads your course folder and does the work itself.

ASSESSMENT

This pilot is assessed on a **completed / not-completed basis** — **there are no letter grades**. You will receive constructive feedback on every deliverable. Success means producing the three deliverables to the standard of the rubrics (shared in Week 1) and a module you could genuinely hand to someone else to teach.

The three deliverables:

- **A — Learning Objectives** (Weeks 1–2): course objectives first (Week 1), then the module objectives that ladder up to them, written once you decompose into modules (Week 2).
- **B — Master Design Document** (Week 2): every module mapped — objectives, topics, materials, activities, values.
- **C — One complete module, built and taught** (Weeks 3–5): structured (Wk 3), produced with GenAI (Wk 4), delivered as a 10-minute teach-back (Wk 5).

ASSIGNMENTS

- **Pre-work** — short reading/preparation before each session so live time is spent producing, not lecturing. Includes coming to Session 1 with the subject you want to build a course on.
- **Live sessions** — five required 2-hour Zoom meetings of instruction, guided building, and feedback. Attendance expected.
- **Between-session production** — the real work: drafting your objectives, MDD, and module. In Week 4 you also run a **Review Council** review of your module and revise, keeping a short AI-direction + verification log.
- **Teach-back** — in Week 5 you deliver a 10-minute segment of your module to the group for live feedback.

WEEKLY SCHEDULE

Week	Pre-work	Live session (2 hr)	Deliverable / by next week
1 — Decide & Write Objectives	Skim the guide; bring your subject	Decisions before production; Bloom objectives; fix-the-weak-objective pair work	Deliverable A (part 1) — finish Decisions doc + course objectives
2 — Master Design Document	Read the seven practices; audit your objectives	Feedback on objectives; build your MDD	Deliverable B — write module objectives as you decompose, finish the MDD, choose your one module
3 — Structure the Module	MDD final; module chosen	Three-package structure; scaffolding; accessibility (UDL); sketch your module skeleton	Flesh out the skeleton — structure, not content yet
4 — Produce With GenAI	Skeleton fleshed out	GenAI production loop + guardrails; planted-error exercise; Review Council	Build the module to the floor; run a Review Council review and revise ; keep a verification log
5 — Teach-Back & Feedback	Module built; segment ready	10-minute teach-backs; structured group + instructor feedback; evaluate & improve	Deliverable C — complete module, built and taught